

UNEP Global Environmental Outlook and Sustainability Assessment Framework

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Chapter 1: The Planetary Crisis and State of Global Ecological Systems

The United Nations Environment Programme assesses global environmental status across climate, biodiversity, land, and water.

Human activities are exerting unprecedented pressure, with four of nine planetary boundaries having already been breached.

Global biodiversity loss is accelerating, with extinction rates estimated at 100 to 1,000 times higher than natural background rates.

Urgent systemic transformations are needed in energy, food, and urban systems to avert catastrophic ecological degradation.

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Chapter 2: Energy Transitions, Material Decoupling, and Circularity

Renewable energy generation has expanded rapidly, reaching 28% of total global electricity generation in recent benchmark years.

Despite clean energy growth, global material consumption reached 100 billion metric tons annually, with circularity at only 8.6%.

Decoupling economic growth from natural resource extraction requires mandatory circular design and extended producer responsibility.

Subsidies for fossil fuels, totaling hundreds of billions of dollars annually, must be redirected to clean technology infrastructure.

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Chapter 3: Policy Interventions and Sustainable Governance Indicators

Governments should adopt natural capital accounting within national GDP metrics to reflect environmental degradation costs and

Legally binding international instruments are recommended to eliminate single-use plastic waste and phase out toxic chemical a

Protected land and marine areas must be expanded to cover at least 30% of global terrestrial and coastal areas by 2030.

Integrated water resource management must safeguard freshwater ecosystems and prevent agricultural nitrogen and phosphor